Upon reaching Qalāt, Babur and his men launched their best attack. Kīchīk Khwāja, the elder brother of Khwāja Kalān fought ferociously and bravely. He was great with his sword, but a spear pierced his eye while he climbed the south-west tower of Qalāt. He couldn't survive the wound and succumbed to it in a couple of days. In the same battle, Kīchīk Bāqī Dīwāna (one who had been arrested for disloyalty) got killed by falling on the rocks below the ramparts. Babur has mentioned that it was his expiation of sordidness. Babur lost a couple of other brave men too. The battle went on till the afternoon prayer, till the men of the fort surrendered asking for a truce.

Ẕū'n-nūn Arghūn had offered Qalāt to Muqīm years ago but was now in control of the latter's retainers Farrukh Arghūn and Qarā Bīlūt (Afghān). Finally, when all were killed, the retainers came out with swords and quivers hanging around their necks. Babur decided not to do anything to them. He has mentioned that he saw no merit in bringing annihilation to this family which he considered a high born.[8] Babur has expressed his view about his situation:[*]

> *It was not my wish to reduce this high family to great straits; for why? Because if we did so when such a foe as the Aūzbeg was at our side, what would be said by those of far and near, who saw and heard?*

Babur had decided to make a move to Qalāt only at the insistence of Bāqī Chaghānīānī and Jahāngīr Mīrzā. Now, Babur made a move to give the whole charge in the hands of Jahāngīr Mīrzā but he rejected the offer. Babur then asked Bāqī Chaghānīānī to take up the responsibility, but he too denied it. This was the moment when Babur found the capture of Qalāt completely useless. The person who had insisted Babur take that step had now denied taking up any responsibility. A disappointed Babur decided to return to Kābul which lied south of Qalāt. On the way, he overran the Afghans of Ālā-tāgh. The night Babur dismounted in Kābul, he anxiously visited the fort, his tent and the stable located in Chārbāgh. In the stable, he came to know that a Khirilchī thief had run away with Babur's mule and one bay horse with its accoutrements.

Bāqī Chaghānīānī Dies

Right from the moment when Babur met Bāqī on the banks of Amu Darya, he had not trusted anyone else more than him.[9] His actual name was Muḥammad Bāqir. Babur has asserted on several occasions that he was a man of command and absolute authority, and Babur followed his calls blindly. Babur didn't shy away from mentioning in the *Baburnama* that all actions that happened were the